# Vireo Audio Pvt. Ltd. — Customer Support Operating Policy

Version 3.2 · Effective 1 April 2025 · Owner: Head of Customer Experience · Internal

## 1. Purpose and scope

This policy defines how the Vireo support desk operates: channels and hours, service levels, cost standards used for planning, refund and replacement rules, team responsibilities and the definitions used in reporting. It applies to all support staff in Bengaluru and Indore and to any vendor working with support data.

## 2. Channels and hours

**Chat** (website and app widget): available 24x7. Overnight coverage is provided by the Indore night shift. **Email**: accepted 24x7, worked in queue order. **Voice**: inbound IVR takes callback requests 08:00-22:00 IST; callbacks are returned by the Voice Frontline team. **Social** (Instagram, X, Facebook): worked by the Chat Frontline team.

The chat bot opens every chat and email ticket with a short intake flow and sets the initial *category* tag from the customer's answers. Agents may correct the tag on closure.

## 3. First-response service levels and breach credits

First response is the first reply by a human agent, measured from ticket creation. Targets: **chat 15 minutes**, **voice callback 2 hours**, **social 4 hours**, **email 8 hours**.

Every ticket that misses its first-response target automatically issues a **store credit of Rs 350** to the customer's account on resolution. The credit is issued regardless of the reason for the breach and is charged to the SLA credit line in the support P&L.

Breaches are reported against the resolving agent in the helpdesk's standard reports.

## 4. Cost standards (FY26 planning figures)

Fully loaded cost per contact, used for all business cases: **chat Rs 210**, **email Rs 260**, **voice callback Rs 520**, **social Rs 240**. Blended across the current channel mix: **Rs 290 per contact**.

Internal transfer between teams: **Rs 305 per transfer** (re-handling and administration). Fully loaded agent cost for staffing decisions: **Rs 165 per agent-hour**. A single agent shift is 8 hours.

## 5. Refunds, replacements and reason codes

**Dead on arrival (within 7 days of delivery)**: customer chooses a full refund *or* a replacement. **In-warranty fault**: repair or replacement. **Lost or damaged in transit**: reshipment or refund. In no case is a customer to receive both a refund and a replacement for the same order; where this happens in error it must be escalated to the Team Lead and Finance the same day.

Replacement cost for planning: the product's **unit cost** (see products.csv) plus **Rs 340** for reverse pickup and forward shipping. Refurbishment recovery is not to be assumed in business cases.

Goodwill credits are capped at **Rs 500** per ticket and require Team Lead approval.

Refund reason codes: **GW-OTHER** Goodwill / Other · **DOA-REPL** Dead on arrival, refund chosen · **LOST-TRANSIT** Lost or undelivered · **DUP-PAYMENT** Duplicate or failed payment · **CANCEL** Cancellation before dispatch · **PRICE-ADJ** Price or coupon adjustment · **RETURN-QC-OK** Return received and passed QC · **WTY-BUYBACK** Warranty buy-back. The code is selected by the agent from a dropdown at the time the refund is raised.

## 6. Teams, tiers and ownership

**Chat, Email and Voice Frontline** (Tier 1) own first contact for product, account and general queries. **Logistics** owns delivery, tracking and reshipment. **Billing** owns payments, invoices and payment-gateway queries. **Returns Desk** owns return pickups and refund processing; it processes the large majority of refunds by design. **Escalations & Warranty** (Tier 2) owns warranty claims, RMA and escalated hardware cases.

Tier 2 work is certified: only Tier 2 agents may approve warranty replacements. Tier 2 cases are multi-touch by nature and are measured on resolution in *days*, not on tickets closed per week. Tier 2 agents are not to be

compared with Tier 1 on volume metrics.

## 7. Shifts and roster

Shifts are defined in **Indian Standard Time**: **Morning 06:00-14:00**, **Day 14:00-22:00**, **Night 22:00-06:00**. The roster is maintained as one row per assignment with from/to dates; an agent who changes site or shift receives a new roster row and keeps the same agent_id. Queue coverage outside a team's staffed hours is picked up by the next shift in order of creation.

## 8. Customer satisfaction (CSAT)

A one-question survey (1-5) is sent when a ticket is resolved. Around 45% of customers respond. **A blank score means no response** and must be excluded from averages, not treated as zero. Tickets auto-closed after 72 hours without a customer reply are recorded as *closed*, count as a completed attendance, and are surveyed.

## 9. Systems and timestamps

The current helpdesk went live on **14 September 2025**. Tickets before that date were migrated from the previous tool (Freshdesk); a subset of legacy tickets was re-imported during reconciliation and may appear in exports under both source systems. The helpdesk displays and exports timestamps in IST in its standard reports. The helpdesk API exports UTC. Resolution timestamps for migrated tickets were reconstructed from the legacy event log, which stores UTC. The legacy tool stored monetary values in its own native unit; the current helpdesk stores rupees.

Each ticket carries the first-assigned team (*assigned_team*) and the agent who resolved it (*agent_id*). The *transfers* field counts hand-offs between teams and exists only in the current helpdesk.

## 10. Reporting definitions

**First-contact resolution**: a ticket is resolved at first contact if the same customer does not contact again about the same issue within 30 days of resolution. A return contact within that window is a *repeat contact* and is costed at the contact cost of the channel used. **Handle time**: first response to resolution. **Breach**: first response later than the target in section 3. **Attendance**: any ticket in status resolved or closed.